

Changes from the Proposal

The main goal of the project has not changed. The task is still to classify the trading intention expressed in finance-related Reddit posts. However, several parts of the data collection and annotation plan changed after we began working with the data.

The original proposal planned to collect posts directly from Reddit using PRAW and the Reddit API. We did not have approved Reddit API credentials, and the approval process could not be completed before the project deadline. Instead, we used the existing Reddit Finance Posts S&P 500 dataset published on Hugging Face. This dataset was originally collected through the Reddit API and is available under the CC BY 4.0 license. Using this source allowed us to collect the required data while still documenting the source and respecting its license.

The proposal focused on a smaller number of finance-related subreddits. The final candidate pool includes posts from 15 finance-related subreddits. We decided that using several relevant communities would provide more variety in writing styles, investment topics, and trading intentions.

We also changed the name of the Noise label to No Clear Trade Intent. The meaning of the label remains similar, but the new name is more understandable for annotators. It clearly explains that the post does not contain one identifiable decision to buy, sell, short, or hold.

The first 50-item internal pilot showed that simple random sampling produced many general discussion posts, relatively few clear Sell examples, and no Hold labels. The pilot also revealed some posts that depended on missing charts, images, portfolios, or outside links. Based on these findings, we added more quality screening and searched the candidate pool for possible Buy, Sell, Short, and Hold language. These search terms were used only to find useful candidates. They were not used to assign labels, and all final labels will still be selected by human annotators.

The annotation guidelines were also expanded after the pilot. We added clearer rules for distinguishing opinions from actions, identifying the writer's action instead of another person's action, handling questions, separating old trades from current intentions, recognizing Hold decisions, and interpreting basic options terminology.

Finally, we selected Potato as the annotation interface. The final setup contains a 50-item shared agreement set and 250 distributed coverage items. The shared posts will be labeled by the internal annotator and every assigned external annotator. Each external annotator will also receive 50 different posts. This design will allow us to measure agreement on the shared items while increasing the total number of posts covered by annotation.

